



THE TAYLOR LEAD FOUNDATION SCHOLARSHIP COMMITTEE PLAYBOOK

ALICE & CHARLES TAYLOR SCHOLAR-ATHLETE LEAD SCHOLARSHIP

**PURPOSE, PROCESS, AND PARTNERSHIP IN RECOGNIZING IDAHO
SCHOLAR-ATHLETES**



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Welcome!

Thank you for joining **The Taylor LEAD Foundation Scholarship Committee.**

We are honored to welcome you into this work and deeply grateful that you have chosen to lend your time, insight, and perspective to the Alice & Charles Taylor Scholar-Athlete LEAD Scholarship. This committee plays an important role in recognizing and investing in Idaho students who are leading with character, commitment, and impact.

This is not simply a scholarship review committee. It is a group of thoughtful stewards who help ensure that the scholarship is administered with integrity, consistency, care, and a deep sense of purpose. As this scholarship grows from its Mountain Home roots into a broader statewide program, your voice helps us both select deserving recipients and strengthen the program for the future. We invited you to serve because we believe your experience, values, and perspective can help us do this work well. We also want you to know that your fresh ideas are welcome. This scholarship is growing, and we see this committee not only as reviewers, but as partners in helping shape a strong and enduring opportunity for Idaho scholar-athletes.

We are grateful you are here.



Who We Are

The Taylor LEAD Foundation exists to invest in leadership, educational excellence, athletic opportunity, and community impact. Through scholarships, grants, programs, and partnerships, the Foundation works to create greater opportunity for young people and communities across Idaho.

At the heart of the Foundation's work is a commitment to helping individuals lead boldly, grow confidently, and contribute meaningfully. The Foundation's initiatives are rooted in the belief that when people are supported, seen, and challenged to grow, they are more likely to create lasting impact in their schools, teams, and communities.

What LEAD Means

The scholarship and related programs are grounded in four core pillars:

- Leadership
- Educational Excellence
- Athletic Achievement
- Distinguished Service

These values guide how we design programs, evaluate applicants, and define success.

Why This Work Matters

The Foundation believes that excellence is not one-dimensional. It is not only about grades, statistics, titles, or awards. It is also about character, resilience, follow-through, growth, service, and the ability to positively influence others. The scholarship program was designed to reflect that broader understanding of what it means to truly lead.



ABOUT THE ALICE & CHARLES TAYLOR SCHOLAR-ATHLETE LEAD SCHOLARSHIP

ORIGINS OF THE SCHOLARSHIP

The Alice & Charles Taylor Scholar-Athlete LEAD Scholarship was created to honor the legacy of Charles and Alice Taylor and the profound influence they had on their family. Their example of hard work, integrity, service, encouragement, and belief in education and athletics helped shape the paths of their children and continues to inspire this scholarship today.

The scholarship was first introduced in 2015 at the Mountain Home High School Athletic Hall of Fame Dinner as a way for Greg, Gary, and Angela Taylor to honor their parents and give back to the community that helped shape their own journeys. What began as a scholarship rooted in Mountain Home High School has since evolved into a broader initiative administered by The Taylor LEAD Foundation.

THE SCHOLARSHIP TODAY

Today, the scholarship recognizes Idaho senior scholar-athletes who embody the LEAD values:

- Leadership
- Educational Excellence
- Athletic Achievement
- Distinguished Service

The scholarship is designed to honor not only achievement, but also effort, resilience, integrity, and community impact.

THE SCHOLARSHIP'S GROWTH

As the program expands, it remains grounded in its original spirit while growing toward a larger statewide vision. The Mountain Home legacy remains important, and the statewide rollout reflects a commitment to broadening access while maintaining the quality and integrity of the program.



Why This Committee Matters

The Scholarship Committee is essential to the credibility, fairness, and long-term strength of this scholarship.

The work of this committee matters because scholarship selection is about more than identifying top performers on paper. It is about carefully reading stories, noticing patterns of effort and leadership, weighing evidence with fairness, and making thoughtful decisions that honor both the applicant and the mission of the scholarship.

This committee helps us:

- ensure the review process is fair and consistent
- identify applicants who truly embody LEAD
- protect the integrity of the scholarship
- strengthen the program over time through insight and feedback
- bring a range of lived experiences and perspectives into the review process
-

Your participation helps us move beyond a narrow or purely transactional approach to selection and toward a process that is rigorous, thoughtful, human, and mission-aligned.

Committee Purpose

The purpose of the Scholarship Committee is to support the thoughtful administration, stewardship, and evolution of the Alice & Charles Taylor Scholar-Athlete LEAD Scholarship.

This includes:

- helping shape and strengthen the scholarship process
- participating in planning conversations and key committee meetings
- serving as Phase I reviewers for scholarship applications
- helping ensure that scholarship recipients reflect the values and spirit of the program
- offering ideas, observations, and recommendations to improve future cycles

What This Committee Is Responsible For

The committee's responsibilities may include:

- reviewing scholarship criteria and materials
- helping refine rubric and process over time
- participating in reviewer calibration and readiness sessions
- completing assigned application reviews by deadline
- identifying strengths, concerns, and trends in the applicant pool
- contributing to semifinalist advancement discussions, when applicable
- supporting debrief and recommendations after each scholarship cycle

COMMITTEE MEMBER ROLE & EXPECTATIONS

YOUR ROLE

As a Scholarship Committee member, you are both a committee participant and a Phase I application reviewer.

Your role includes contributing to committee conversations, reviewing applications in a timely and thoughtful manner, and helping us maintain a selection process that is fair, consistent, and reflective of the scholarship's mission.

EXPECTATIONS	AS A COMMITTEE MEMBER, WE ASK THAT YOU:
Participate with integrity	Approach this work with care, fairness, respect, and professionalism.
Complete assigned reviews on time	Read each assigned application thoroughly and submit scores and comments by the stated deadline.
Maintain confidentiality	Protect applicant information and committee deliberations. Application materials and discussions should not be shared outside the official process.
Disclose conflicts of interest	Notify the committee leadership if you recognize an applicant or have any connection that may affect your neutrality.
Engage in committee learning and calibration	Attend orientation, training, and calibration sessions so that scoring is as aligned and fair as possible.
Bring your perspective	We value your professional insight, lived experience, and thoughtful observations. You are encouraged to share ideas that strengthen the scholarship and the review process.

WHAT WE HOPE MEMBERS EXPERIENCE

We want committee members to feel:

- informed
- respected
- well equipped
- connected to the mission
- excited to contribute
- confident in what is expected of them

The Kind of Student We Are Looking For

The ideal applicant is not simply the student with the highest GPA, the most awards, or the longest résumé. We are looking for students who demonstrate a meaningful combination of achievement, character, effort, growth, and impact.

A strong applicant will show evidence of the LEAD pillars in ways that are authentic and grounded in their real experience.

LEAD in Practice

Leadership

The applicant demonstrates initiative, accountability, integrity, and positive influence. Leadership may be formal or informal. We care about how they show up, how they help others, and how they respond when something needs to be done.

Athletic Achievement

The applicant has shown meaningful involvement in sports through commitment, growth, teamwork, resilience, and contribution. Athletic participation may include school, club, recreation, or adaptive sports.

Educational Excellence

The applicant shows commitment to learning, academic effort, and growth. This includes GPA, rigor where available, persistence, and evidence that they take their education seriously.

Distinguished Service

The applicant has contributed to their school or community in ways that demonstrate care for others and a willingness to serve beyond themselves.

Additional Qualities We Value

We also pay attention to:

- resilience
- consistency
- self-awareness
- purpose
- follow-through
- character
- how well the student uses the opportunities available to them

What Makes an Ideal Applicant

Scholarship Structure & Statewide Rollout

Statewide Expansion

The scholarship is being expanded across Idaho in phases to ensure a sustainable and high-quality statewide rollout.

Current-Year Eligibility

For the **2025–26 school year**, the scholarship is open to students attending eligible high schools in:

- **District III**
- **District IV**

In addition, the scholarship's Mountain Home roots remain important, and legacy recognition for Mountain Home High School continues as part of the program.

Future Rollout

Additional districts will become eligible in future scholarship cycles as the program continues to expand statewide.

Award Structure

The scholarship may recognize:

up to **10 recipients across District III and District IV combined**

up to **4 recipients in Mountain Home**

Award numbers and amounts may vary based on funding availability and the strength of the applicant pool.



Application Components

What Applicants Submit

Applicants complete a scholarship application through Submittable that includes several required components. Reviewers should be familiar with all elements of the application.

Core Application Components

- applicant information
- school and graduation information
- trans/crypt / GPA
- athletic participation details
- service/community involvement
- short written responses aligned to LEAD
- scholar statement
- contextual information, if shared
- recommendations
- video interview

Recommendations

Applicants are required to request:

- **two required statements of recommendation**
 - at least one teacher
 - at least one coach
- **one optional statement**
 - may be from a teacher, coach, or community leader

Video Interview

All applicants will submit a short video interview that becomes part of the later review process.

Reviewer Note

Not every student will present themselves with the same level of polish. Reviewers should focus on substance, evidence, character, and impact rather than writing style alone.

Understanding the Target Audience

PHASE I

Initial Application Review

Scholarship Committee members serve as **Phase I reviewers**. During this stage, reviewers assess written applications using the LEAD rubric.

This phase focuses on:

- Leadership
- Educational Excellence
- Athletic Achievement
- Distinguished Service
- Scholar Statement

Each reviewer scores assigned applications independently.

PHASE II

Final Review

After the full Scholarship Committee narrows the field, a smaller final review group or Board Selection Committee reviews semifinalists/finalists. This later phase incorporates:

- prior Phase I scores
- recommendation content
- video interview review
- final composite scoring and deliberation

Suggested Advancement

A smaller group of semifinalists is advanced from each pool for final review.

Why the Process Is Structured This Way

This structure allows:

- broad perspective in the first round
- consistency in scoring
- deeper review of the strongest applicants
- thoughtful final deliberation

How to Review Well

A strong reviewer reads carefully, scores consistently, and looks for evidence rather than assumptions.

Look for substance

Focus on what the applicant actually did, what impact they had, and what they learned.

Avoid over-weighting polish

Students come from different schools, resources, and support systems. Strong writing can be helpful, but polish should not outweigh evidence of effort or impact.

Pay attention to outcomes

When possible, look for:

- what changed because of the student's actions
- who benefited
- whether the student demonstrated growth or leadership

Consider context thoughtfully

Some students are balancing school with:

- work
- caregiving
- transportation limitations
- fewer access points to activities or advanced coursework

Context is not scored, but it can help reviewers fairly interpret effort and opportunity.

Use comments strategically

Brief comments should support your score and note specific evidence, not just general impressions.

Helpful Reviewer Mindset

Ask:

- What is the applicant showing me?
- What is strongest here?
- What evidence supports this score?
- Am I rewarding privilege or actual impact?
- Would another reviewer understand why I scored this way?

Recommendations & Video Interview Overview

Recommendations

Recommendations help provide perspective from adults who know the student in meaningful settings. These are incorporated later in the process and should not completely override the applicant's own materials, but they can add helpful evidence and context.

We ask recommenders to comment on:

- strengths
- growth
- leadership
- character
- community impact
- endorsement level

Video Interview

The video interview allows applicants to share their voice more directly and gives the final review process a fuller picture of:

- communication
- reflection
- authenticity
- mission fit
- readiness and purpose

The interview should be evaluated based on content, not production quality, background, or presentation resources.



Submittable Overview

Using Submittable as a Reviewer

Submittable is the platform we use to collect applications and manage reviews. Committee members will receive assignments and complete their scoring directly in the platform.

What Reviewers Will Do in Submittable

log into the reviewer portal

open assigned applications

review applicant responses
and uploaded materials

complete rubric scores

enter brief comments as
needed

submit reviews by the stated
deadline

Support Materials

All committee members will receive:

- a Submittable tutorial video
- written reviewer instructions
- a contact for technical support or questions

Best Practice

Do not wait until the last day to begin reviews. Starting early allows time for technical support, questions, and thoughtful scoring.

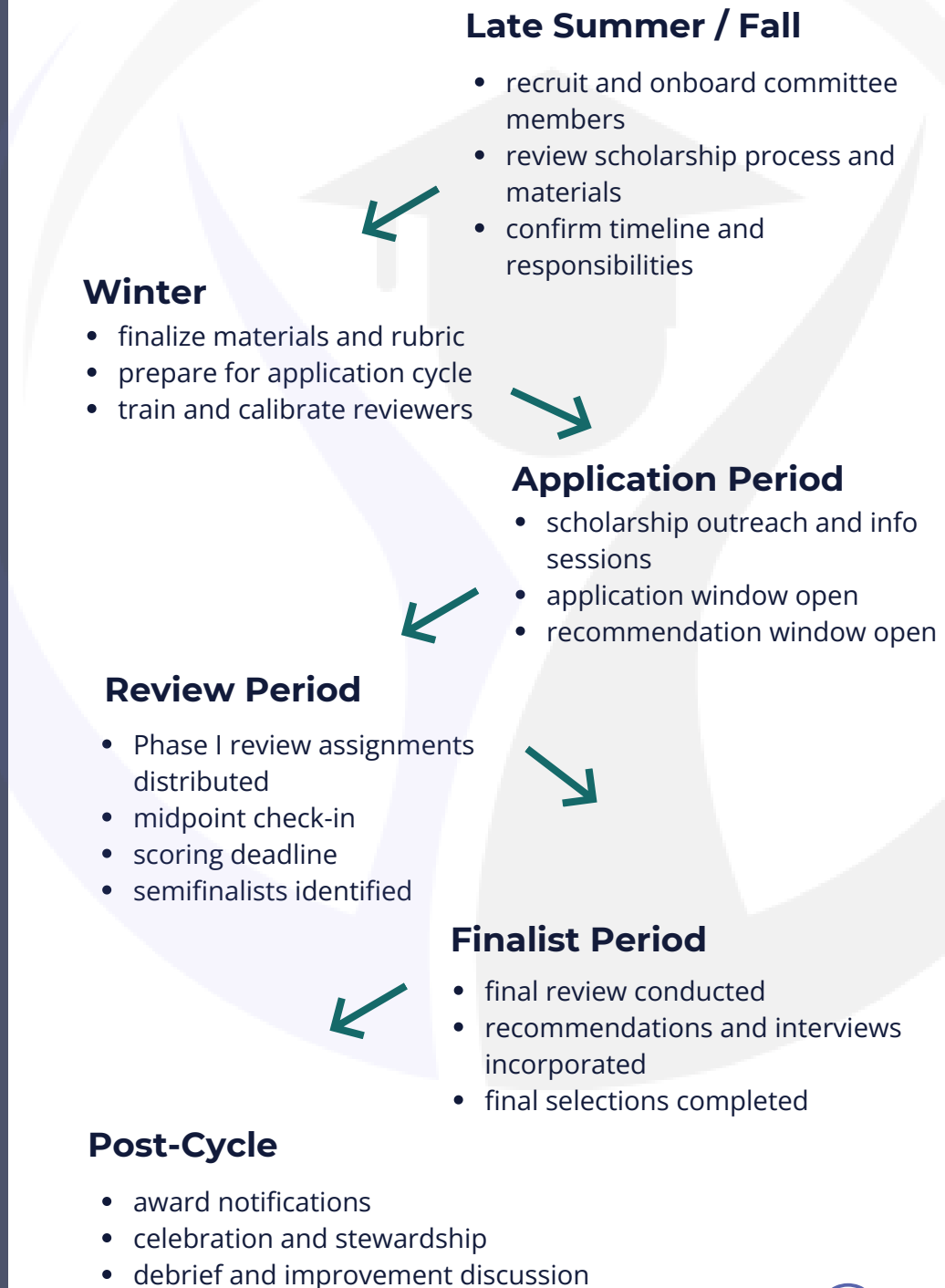
Meeting Cadence & Scholarship Calendar

Meeting Cadence

The Scholarship Committee will generally meet:

- **monthly** during planning and onboarding periods
- **bi-weekly**, as needed, during active review periods
- **once after the cycle** for debrief and improvement recommendations

Typical Annual Rhythm



Confidentiality, Fairness & Conflict of Interest

CONFIDENTIALITY

Committee members are entrusted with personal information from student applicants. This trust must be honored at all times.

Please do not:

- share applications or scores outside the official process
- discuss applicant details with people outside the committee
- save or distribute student materials outside approved systems

FAIRNESS

Our goal is to create a process that is equitable, respectful, and grounded in evidence. This means:

- following the rubric
- applying standards consistently
- avoiding favoritism
- checking personal assumptions and bias
- treating each applicant with dignity

CONFLICT OF INTEREST

A conflict of interest may arise if:

- you know the student personally
- you are related to the student
- you work directly with the student
- you believe your objectivity may be affected
-

If a conflict exists or might exist, notify committee leadership immediately. You may be reassigned that application.

Committee Culture & Contribution

The Kind of Committee We Want to Build

We want this committee to feel thoughtful, collaborative, and mission-driven.

That means we aim to build a culture that is:

- respectful
- prepared
- generous
- curious
- honest
- improvement-oriented

Your Perspective Matters

We are not looking for committee members to simply “go along” with an existing process. We want people who will help us strengthen it. If you notice something that could be clearer, fairer, more accessible, or more effective, we want to hear it.

This scholarship is growing, and one of the greatest strengths of this committee is the fresh perspective each member brings.



Resources & Links

Core Materials

Committee members will be provided access to:

- Scholarship Committee welcome email
- Scholarship Committee onboarding form
- Scholarship Info Sessions recording
- Taylor LEAD Partner Portal
- Submittable tutorial video
- reviewer rubric
- scholarship application PDF
- recommendation form
- review timeline and calendar
- conflict of interest guidance

Primary Contacts

President & Co-Founder:

Angela Taylor

Vice President, Co-Founder & Co-Chair:

Gary Taylor

Board Member & Co-Chair:

Trisha Stevens Lamb

Support Email:

hello@taylorleadscholarship.com

Scholarship Questions:

hello@taylorleadscholarship.com





APPENDIX

Appendix A: LEAD Rubric Summary

Leadership — 25%

One strong example with outcomes and a clear sense of where/how the student leads.

Educational Excellence — 25%

GPA, transcript, and evidence of academic effort, growth, and excellence.

Athletic Achievement — 20%

Sports participation, commitment, teamwork, growth, and resilience.

Distinguished Service — 20%

School/community service and evidence of meaningful contribution.

Scholar Statement — 10%

Mission fit, future goals, and overall alignment with the scholarship.

Contextual Factors — non-scored

Work hours, caregiving, first-generation status, access barriers, and other relevant context may be used as tie-breaker lens only.

Appendix B: Reviewer Quick Reminders

- Read the full application before scoring
- Focus on evidence, not assumptions
- Avoid over-rewarding polish or access
- Use comments to support your ratings
- Flag conflicts immediately
- Submit reviews on time

Appendix C: Recommended Onboarding Checklist

Before beginning Phase I review, each committee member should complete the following:

- Read the Scholarship Committee Playbook
- Complete the new member intake form
- Watch the Submittable tutorial video
- Review the scholarship application PDF
- Watch the Scholarship Info Session recording
- Visit the Taylor LEAD Partner Portal
- Attend orientation meeting
- Attend reviewer calibration session



Closing Note

Thank you for serving on The Taylor LEAD Foundation Scholarship Committee. Your thoughtful participation helps us do more than select scholarship recipients. It helps us honor a legacy, recognize emerging leaders, and invest in the next generation of Idaho students who are leading with excellence in the classroom, in athletics, and in their communities.

We are grateful for your partnership, your perspective, and your commitment to this work.

